1574 and participated in the ibadat khana discussions where he used his great learning to humiliate the ulema. He wrote the *Akbarnama* and the *Ain-i Akbari*, in which he detailed his ideas, including the Ibn Arabi notion of the ruler as a perfect man. His influence on Akbar was resented by many, including by Akbar's son, Salim, who had him assassinated by Bir Singh Deo.

Abu'l Faiz (1547–1595): Son of Shaikh Mubarak and elder brother of Abu'l Fazl. Known by his pen name Faizi. A Persian poet and a scholar, he became poet laureate of Akbar's court in 1588, and was appointed tutor to Akbar's sons.

Raja Todar Mal (d. 1589): Supremely talented Hindu finance minister. Brought in many changes to the revenue collection of the state, making it more efficient and profitable.

Fath Allah Shirazi: A learned Shia scholar from Iran, who first served at the court of Ali Adil Shah of Bijapur before joining Akbar's court. An erudite and knowledgeable man, he was a great favourite of Akbar's and was instrumental in introducing financial reforms in revenue collection alongside Raja Todar Mal. He was named joint wazir along with the raja.

OPPONENTS AND REBELS

Abdullah Khan Uzbek: Uzbek clansman, rebelled against Akbar.

Ali Quli Khan Uzbek and **Bahadur Khan Uzbek:** Brothers who came to Hindustan in the train of Humayun. Rebelled against Akbar and were defeated.

Bahadur Shah: Ruler of Khandesh from the Faruqui dynasty. Refused to submit to the Mughal forces when they advanced on Khandesh. Resisted at Asirgarh fortress where he was besieged for almost a year by Akbar's forces. Surrendered to Akbar in 1600 and died in captivity.

Baz Bahadur: Sultan of Malwa, Sur dynasty. Well known as a connoisseur of music and poetry. Paramour of Roopmati. Was defeated by the Mughals, and later incorporated into the empire.

Bir Singh Deo: Younger son of Raja Madhukar Bundela of Orchha. Rebelled against the naming of his elder brother to the gaddi of Orchha upon the death of his father. Sought Prince Salim's help, who in turn asked